The GUESS Kitchen

Basic recipes for every GUESS cookbook: getting data in, cleaning it, asking questions, measuring, finding structure, drawing and sharing

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About these cookbooks

Each "GUESS for X" cookbook is a set of short recipes for one field. This one, the Kitchen, holds what they all share. The field books link back here instead of repeating it.

Every recipe has the same parts:

- **You have / you want**: the situation and the goal, so you can tell quickly whether the recipe is the one you need.
- **Ingredients**: the data and commands it uses.
- **Steps**: code to type into the GUESS console (or paste, then Shift+Enter). Each recipe starts from scratch and loads its own data.
- **How it works**: what the commands did, and what the result means.
- **Variations** and **pitfalls**: related tasks, and where the method misleads.

Recipes are tagged *Basic*, *Intermediate* or *Advanced*. The data files named in the steps are in the cookbooks' `data` folder. Open them with *File* → *Open* (or drag them onto the page) and GUESS keeps a copy, so `makeFromGDF("karate.gdf")` finds it afterwards. `sample.gdf` is the graph GUESS opens with.

Every code sample in these books is run by the build, so if a recipe doesn't work as printed, that's a bug: please report it.

Getting data in

Open a network file Basic

You have a network saved by another tool. **You want** it in GUESS.

Ingredients: `karate.gdf` · `makeFromGDF` and friends

```
makeFromGDF("karate.gdf")
```

How it works. Each format has its own loader. All of them replace the current graph, turn the file's

attributes into fields, and keep the file's positions if it has them:

format	command
GDF (GUESS, GUESS 2006)	`makeFromGDF`
GraphML (yEd, Cytoscape, networkx)	`makeFromGraphML`
GEXF (Gephi)	`makeFromGEXF`
GML	`makeFromGML`
DOT (Graphviz)	`makeFromDOT`
Pajek `.net`	`makeFromPajek`
UCINET DL	`makeFromDL`
CSV / TSV	`makeFromCSV` (next recipe)

File → Open picks the loader from the file's extension. In a script, `makeFromURL("https://…/graph.gexf")` downloads and opens a file in one step.

Variations. `makeSample()` lists the classic networks GUESS has built in (the karate club, *Les Misérables*, Florentine families, Davis's southern women…). `makeSample("karate")` opens one without a file.

Build a network from a spreadsheet Basic

You have a table of who is linked to whom. **You want** a network.

Ingredients: `friends.csv` (columns Source, Target, Weight) · `makeFromCSV`

```
makeFromCSV("friends.csv")
getEdgeSchema()
```

How it works. A CSV whose first two columns are named Source and Target (as Gephi expects) is read as an edge table: one row per edge, and every other column becomes an edge field (`weight` here). A first row of node names and a first column of the same names is read as an adjacency matrix instead. Edges are undirected unless the table has a Type column saying `Directed`, or you pass `directed=true`.

Pitfalls. Spreadsheets often list a tie once in each direction, or repeat it per contact. Here, `ana,ben` appears three times. See *Merge duplicate edges into weights*.

Add attributes from a second table Basic

You have a network, plus a spreadsheet of facts about the nodes (age, team, gene expression…). **You want** those facts as node fields.

Ingredients: `friends.csv` · `friends-nodes.csv` (columns Id, team, age)

```
makeFromCSV("friends.csv")
makeFromCSV("friends-nodes.csv")
ana.team, ana.age
```

How it works. Opening a CSV with an `Id` column but no Source/Target doesn't replace the graph. It adds the columns to the nodes whose names match the Id, and creates nodes for Ids that aren't in the network yet (`ivy`, who has no ties). Numbers become numeric fields, so `age > 30` works straight away.

Variations. `makeFromCSV("edges.csv", "nodes.csv")` reads both tables at once.

Bring in a networkx or igraph graph Intermediate

You have a graph built in Python, or want an algorithm GUESS doesn't have. **You want** to move between GUESS and networkx.

Ingredients: `toNetworkX` · `fromNetworkX` · `setField`

```
makeFromGDF("karate.gdf")
import networkx as nx
G = toNetworkX()
setField(nx.load_centrality(G), "load")
sortBy(load)[-3:]
```

How it works. `toNetworkX()` hands you the current graph with every field as an attribute. `setField(result, "name")` stores what a networkx function returns: a dict of node values becomes a node field, a dict of node pairs becomes an edge field, and a list of node sets (communities) becomes a field holding each node's group number. `fromNetworkX(G)` goes the other way and replaces the graph.

Cleaning

Merge duplicate edges into weights Basic

You have the same tie listed many times. **You want** one edge per pair, weighted by how often (or how much) it occurred.

Ingredients: `friends.csv` · `simplify`

```
makeFromCSV("friends.csv")
simplify()
(ana <-> ben).weight
```

How it works. `simplify()` merges edges joining the same two nodes (in the same direction, for directed edges) and adds up their weights. It also removes self-loops (`fay` to `fay`). `combine="max"`, `"mean"`, `"min"` or `"first"` combine weights differently. It's one undo step.

Drop isolates and keep the main component Basic

You have a network with stray nodes and small fragments. **You want** to analyse the connected core.

Ingredients: `friends.csv`, `friends-nodes.csv` · `giantComponent` · `removeDisconnected`

```
makeFromCSV("friends.csv"); makeFromCSV("friends-nodes.csv"); simplify()
removeDisconnected()                # ivy, who has no ties
showOnly(giantComponent())          # hide gus and hal's pair
```

How it works. `removeDisconnected()` deletes nodes with no edges and returns them. `giantComponent()` is the largest connected piece. `showOnly` hides the rest without deleting it (`showAll()` brings it back), while `remove(g.nodes - giantComponent())` deletes it.

Pitfalls. Measures like closeness and average path length are only meaningful within a component. Decide whether fragments are noise or findings before you drop them.

Make, rename and fill fields Basic

You have values to store or derive. **You want** them as fields you can query, colour and size by.

```
makeFromGDF("sample.gdf")
addNodeField("senior", BOOLEAN, false)
(dept == "dept4").senior = true
addEdgeField("heavy", BOOLEAN, false)
(freq > 50).heavy = true
getNodeSchema()
```

How it works. `addNodeField(name, type, default)` and `addEdgeField` create a field with a default value. Assigning to a set (`(… ).senior = true`) sets it on every member. The types are `VARCHAR` (text), `INTEGER`, `DOUBLE`, `BOOLEAN`. Python works too: `for n in g.nodes: n.senior = n.degree > 5`.

Asking questions

Select by value Basic

You have a field. **You want** the nodes or edges that match.

```
makeFromGDF("sample.gdf")
dept4 = (dept == "dept4")
busy = (freq > 100)
dept.find("dept9")                  # the same as dept == "dept9"
(dept like "dept1%")                # SQL patterns: % any run, _ one character
len(dept4), len(busy)
```

How it works. In GUESS, comparing a field with a value doesn't give `True/False`; it gives the set of matching elements. Sets can be coloured, hidden, counted or passed to any command. `field.find(value)` is a plain-method spelling of `field == value`.

Combine and subtract sets Basic

```
makeFromGDF("sample.gdf")
a = (dept == "dept4")
b = (degree > 5)
(a & b).color = red                 # in dept4 and well connected
(a | b).size = 20                   # either
a.difference(b).color = orange      # in dept4 but not well connected
```

How it works. `&` is intersection and `|` union, and `.difference()` removes members. They work on any GUESS sets, including edges. Assigning a field on a set assigns it on every member.

Pitfalls. Between sets of nodes, `-` doesn't subtract: `a - b` is the *edges* joining `a` and `b` (see the next recipe). Use `.difference()`.

Find the edges between groups Basic

You want the ties linking two sets of nodes, or the ties of one node.

```
makeFromGDF("sample.gdf")
a = (dept == "dept4"); b = (dept == "dept9")
(a <-> b).color = red                # edges between the two departments (also a - b)
(v1 -> g.nodes).width = 4             # v1's outgoing edges
interEdges(dept).color = gray         # every edge that crosses departments
```

How it works. `->`, `<-` and `<->` between nodes or sets give the edges in that direction (`<->` either way). `interEdges(field)` and `intraEdges(field)` give the edges that cross between values of a field or stay within one.

Rank and group Basic

```
makeFromGDF("sample.gdf")
sortBy(betweenness)[-5:]                    # the top five
[(grp[0].dept, len(grp)) for grp in groupBy(dept)]
dept.distinct                               # every value once
table(dept == "dept4")                      # look at them in the data table
```

How it works. `sortBy(field)` sorts ascending, so the largest values are at the end. `groupBy(field)` returns one set per value, and `groupAndSortBy` orders the groups by size. `table(seq)` opens the data table on just those rows, where you can sort columns and edit values.

Measuring

Size, density and the usual summary Basic

```
makeFromGDF("karate.gdf")
graphStats()
```

How it works. `graphStats()` prints the measures most papers report: nodes, edges, density, mean degree, components, diameter, average path length, average clustering, transitivity and degree assortativity (plus reciprocity for directed graphs). Each is also a command on its own (`density()`, `diameter()`, `transitivity()`...).

Who is central? Basic

You want to find the important nodes, and to know which kind of important you mean.

```
makeFromGDF("karate.gdf")
frLayout()
sizeBy(betweenness, 8, 40)
colorBy(closeness, yellow, red)
labelBy(label)
```

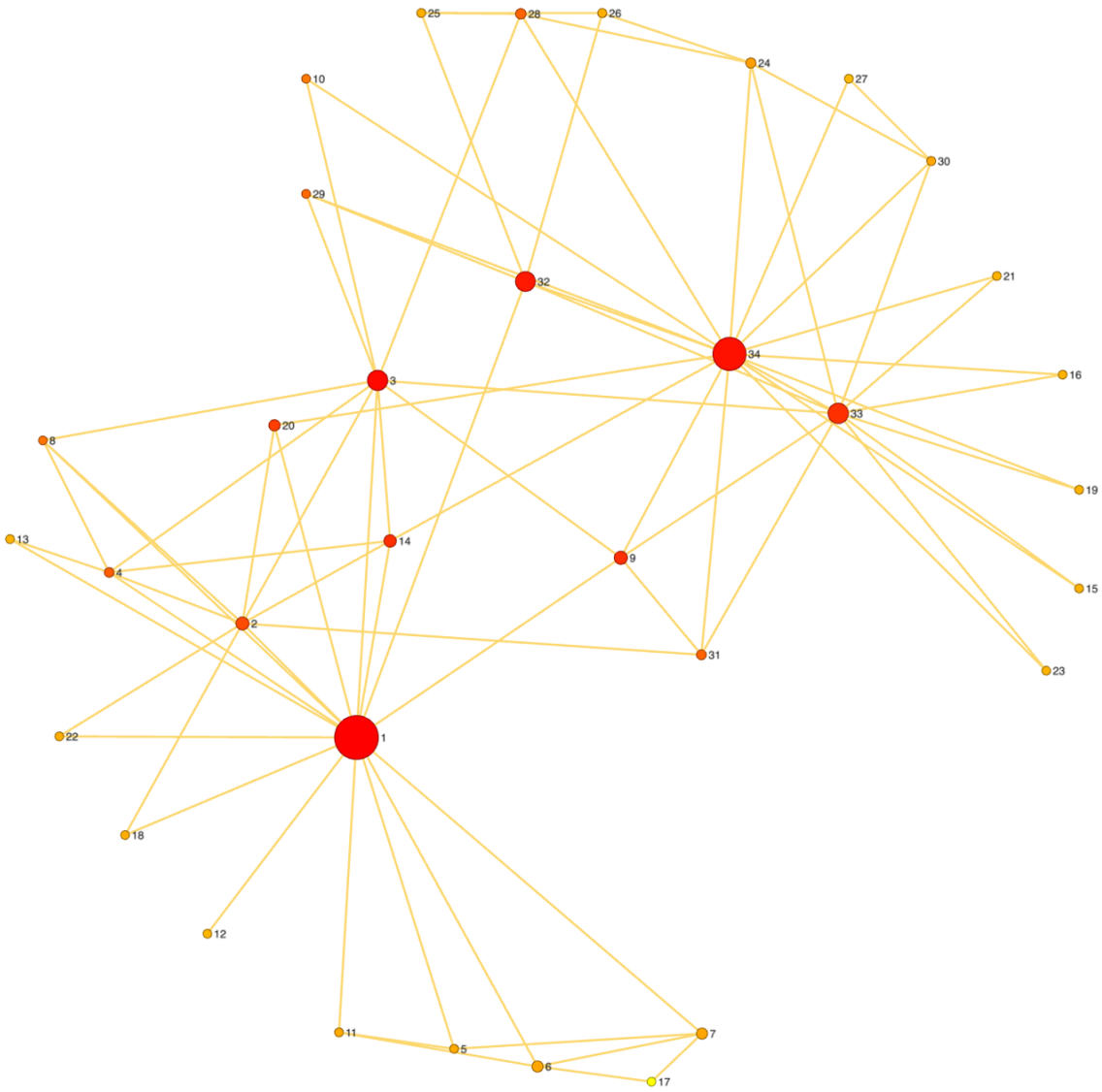


Figure 1: Karate club members sized by betweenness and coloured by closeness

How it works. These centrality fields are computed the first time you use them:

field	high when a node…
`degree`, `indegree`, `outdegree`	has many ties
`strength`	has heavy ties (sum of weights)
`betweenness`	lies on many shortest paths: a broker or gatekeeper
`closeness`, `harmonic`	is few steps from everyone (`harmonic` copes with fragments)
`eigenvector`	is tied to nodes that are themselves well tied

field	high when a node…
`pagerank`	is pointed to by important nodes (directed)
`hub`, `authority`	points to good authorities / is pointed to by good hubs
`constraint`, `effsize`	spans structural holes (Burt): low constraint = broker
`coreness`	sits in a deep k-core

Pitfalls. Centralities disagree, and the disagreement is informative: a node with low degree but high betweenness is a bridge between groups. Don't report "the most central" node without saying which measure.

Look at distributions Basic

```
makeFromGDF("lesmis.gdf")
plotHistogram(degree)
plotDistrib(betweenness)
```

How it works. `plotHistogram(field)` counts values in bins. `plotDistrib(field)` plots each node's value in rank order, which makes heavy tails (a few hubs, many small nodes) obvious. The charts appear in a panel and can be saved as images.

Paths and distances Basic

```
makeFromGDF("lesmis.gdf")
p = shortestPath(Napoleon, Javert)
p.color = red
heatMap(Valjean)                        # colour everyone by hops from Valjean
averagePathLength(), diameter()
```

How it works. `shortestPath(a, b)` returns the nodes and edges of one shortest path. `weighted=true` treats the edge weight as a length (so heavier means farther; invert weights first if they measure strength). `heatMap(node)` colours by distance and stores it in `hops`.

Finding structure

Components, bridges and cut points Basic

```
makeFromGDF("sample.gdf")
colorize(component)
bridges().color = red                   # edges whose removal splits a part
cutNodes().size = 25                    # nodes whose removal splits a part
```

How it works. `component` numbers each connected piece (0 = largest). `strongcomponent` is the directed version. A bridge is the only link between two parts. A cut node holds two parts together. Both are where a network is fragile.

Cores and cliques Intermediate

```
makeFromGDF("karate.gdf")
colorBy(coreness, lightgray, red)
largestCliques()
showOnly(kCore(4))
```

How it works. The *k*-core is what remains after repeatedly removing nodes with fewer than *k* ties. `coreness` is the deepest core each node belongs to. A clique is a group in which everyone is tied to everyone. `largestCliques()` returns the biggest ones. Cores are robust and cliques are brittle (one missing tie breaks a clique), so prefer cores for noisy data.

Communities Basic

You want groups of nodes more tied to each other than to the rest.

```
makeFromGDF("karate.gdf")
frLayout()
leidenClusters()
colorize(leiden_class)
createConvexHull(leiden_class == 0, "255,200,200,90")
legendFor(leiden_class)
```

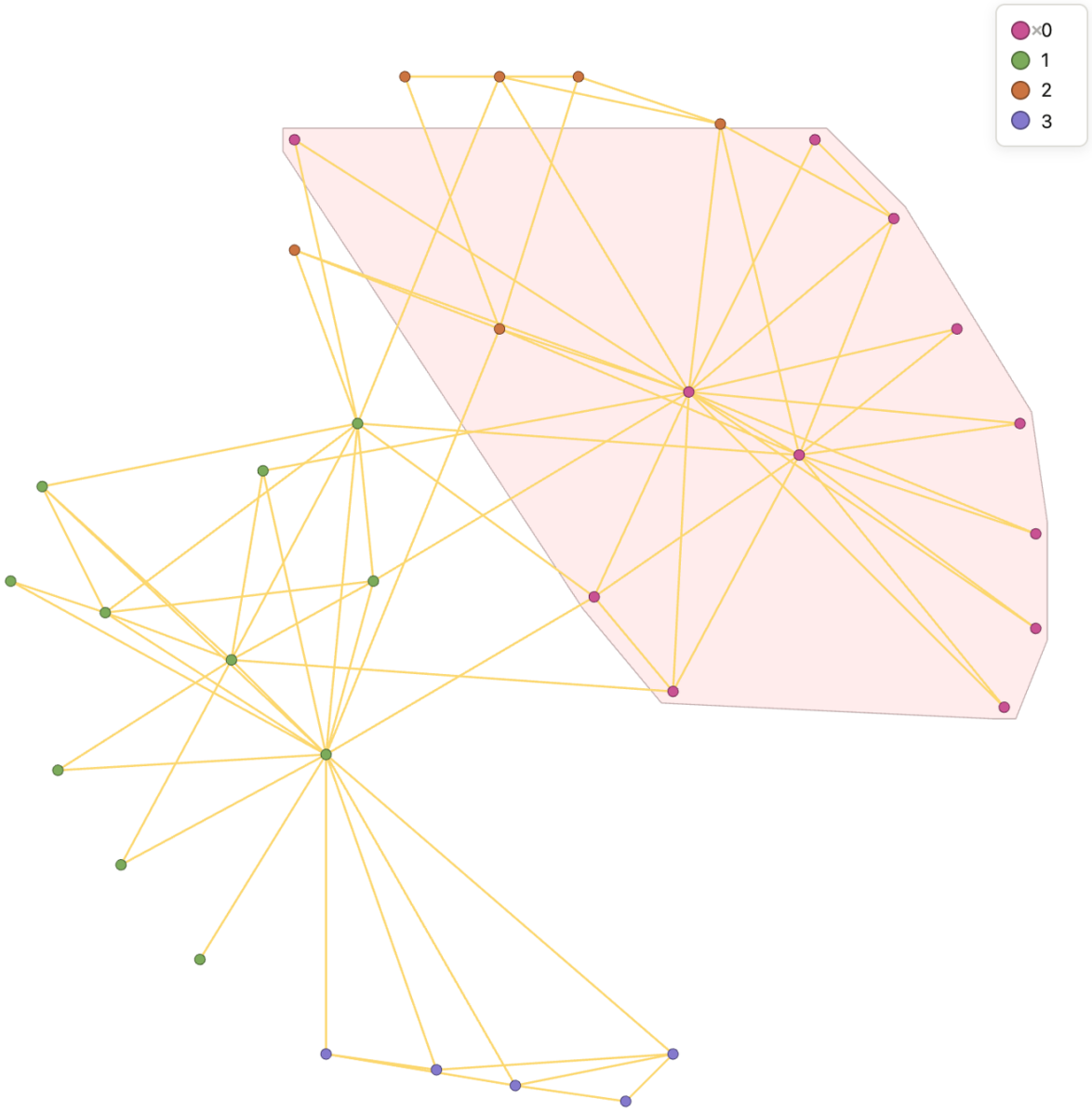


Figure 2: Leiden communities in the karate club

How it works. GUESS has many community methods. Each stores the result as a field (0 = the largest community):

command	field	good for
`louvainClusters()`	`modularity_class`	fast, standard (Gephi's "Modularity")
`leidenClusters()`	`leiden_class`	like Louvain, but every community is connected
`infomapClusters()`	`infomap_class`	directed flow: citations, web links

command	field	good for
`walktrapClusters()`, `fastGreedyClusters()`, `labelPropagationClusters()`, …		alternatives to compare
`edgeBetweennessClusters(n)`		small graphs; a hierarchy you can cut

`resolution=` (Louvain, Leiden) above 1 gives more, smaller communities. `modularity(field)` scores any partition, including one you supply (`modularity(dept)`).

Pitfalls. Every method finds communities, even in random graphs. Check that the modularity is well above what you get after `rewire()`, and that the result is stable (`seed=None`, run again, then `compareClusters`).

Compare two groupings Intermediate

```
makeFromGDF("sample.gdf")
louvainClusters()
compareClusters(modularity_class, dept)              # 0 = unrelated, 1 = identical
compareClusters(modularity_class, dept, method="ari")
mixingMatrix(dept)
```

How it works. `compareClusters` gives normalized mutual information (or the adjusted Rand index) between two partitions, such as found communities and a known attribute. `mixingMatrix(field)` counts edges between each pair of values, which shows *which* groups mix.

Collapse groups into single nodes Intermediate

```
makeFromGDF("sample.gdf")
collapseBy(dept)
```

How it works. Each department becomes one meta-node, with edges summarising the ties between departments. `expand(node)` or `expandAll()` opens them again. Double-clicking a meta-node in the display does the same.

Laying out

Choose a layout Basic

```
makeFromGDF("lesmis.gdf")
forceAtlas2Layout()
```

How it works. No layout is “correct”. Choose by what you want to see:

you want	try
clusters to separate	`forceAtlas2Layout()`, `frLayout()`, `sfdpLayout()` (large graphs)
distances to mean graph distance	`kkLayout()`, `neatoLayout()`, `mdsLayout()`
a hierarchy or flow, top to bottom	`dotLayout()`, `sugiyamaLayout()`, `dagLayout()`
one node's view of the world	`radialLayout(node)`, `twopiLayout()`
groups on a circle	`circleLayout()`, `circoLayout()`, `hiveLayout(field)`
two kinds of node	`bipartiteLayout(field)`
attributes as coordinates	`scatterLayout(xfield, yfield)`

Layouts start from the current positions, so running one twice refines it. `removeOverlap()` (or `noverlapLayout()`) pushes overlapping nodes apart afterwards.

Pin nodes while the rest moves Basic

```
makeFromGDF("karate.gdf")
m1.x, m1.y = 100, 500
m34.x, m34.y = 900, 500
(m1, m34).fixed = true
frLayout()
```

How it works. Nodes with `fixed = true` stay put during layouts, and the others arrange themselves around them. Here the two rival leaders anchor the two ends of the picture. Dragging a node with the mouse also moves it.

Drawing

Colour, size and shape by data Basic

```
makeFromGDF("sample.gdf")
colorize(dept)                    # a distinct colour per value
sizeBy(degree, 6, 30)             # proportional to a number
shapeBy(jobfun)                   # a shape per value
sizeBy(freq, 1, 6)                # edge widths, for an edge field
legendFor(dept)
```

How it works. `colorize` is for categories; `colorBy(field, low, high)` is a gradient for numbers. `sizeBy(field, min, max)` scales sizes (`scale="log"` or `"sqrt"` for skewed values). `resizeLinear` spaces sizes by rank. Legends follow the colours: re-run `colorize` and the legend updates.

Labels that don't collide Basic

```
makeFromGDF("lesmis.gdf")
forceAtlas2Layout()
sizeBy(degree, 5, 30)
g.nodes.labelvisible = true
```

```
g.nodes.labelpos = "outside"
optimizeLabels()
hideOverlappingLabels()
```

How it works. `labelpos` is where a node's label goes: `"right"`, `"center"`, `"inside"` (fitted into the shape), or `"outside"`, which lets GUESS choose a free spot. `optimizeLabels()` runs a longer search for positions, and `hideOverlappingLabels()` drops the labels that still collide, smallest nodes first. `labelSizeBy(degree)` makes important labels bigger.

Outline groups and bundle the hairball Intermediate

```
makeFromGDF("lesmis.gdf")
forceAtlas2Layout()
louvainClusters(); colorize(modularity_class)
for grp in groupBy(modularity_class): createConvexHull(grp)
bundleEdges()
```

How it works. `createConvexHull(set)` shades the area around a set of nodes. `bundleEdges()` gathers edges that run in the same direction into bundles (MINGLE). `method="fdeb"` gives smoother curves, and passing a field (`bundleEdges(modularity_class)`) bundles within groups. `unbundleEdges()` undoes it.

Explore a crowded area with the lens Basic

Press **L** (or the Lens button in the toolbar) and move over a dense area: the lens lists the labels of everything under it, in a column beside the cursor, with lines to each node. The mouse wheel resizes it, Shift+wheel scrolls long lists, and a click pins it. `excentricLens(true, radius=80)` turns it on from the console.

Change over time

Save, compare and animate states Intermediate

```
makeFromGDF("karate.gdf")
frLayout()
ss("before")
remove(m1)                          # what if the instructor leaves?
colorize(component)
ss("after")
morph("before", 1500)
```

How it works. `ss(name)` saves the whole graph (membership, positions, every field) as a named state. `ls(name)` returns to it, and `morph(name, ms)` animates the change. Fields can be read in a state: `betweenness["before"]`, `m2["before"].color`. States can be named with numbers (`ss(1999)`), which suits snapshots over time.

Show a network as of a date Intermediate

```
makeFromGDF("sample.gdf")
addEdgeField("since", INTEGER, 0)
for e in g.edges: e.since = e.freq          # pretend freq is a year
showTime(60, since)                         # edges that exist by "60"
showTime(150, since, window=50)             # only the last 50
```

How it works. `showTime(t, field)` shows only elements whose numeric field is at most `t` (and within `window` of it, if given). For elements that come and go, give them ranges with `addRange(node, "1999-2003,2007")` and use `showTime(t)`. *View* → *Timeline* gives a slider.

Sharing

Export a figure Basic

```
makeFromGDF("karate.gdf")
frLayout(); colorize(club)
exportSVG("karate.svg")
exportPDF("karate.pdf")
exportPNG("karate.png")
```

How it works. SVG and PDF are vector: the whole graph, at any size, with labels and legends, ready for a paper. PNG is the current view as you see it.

Tell a story with slides Intermediate

```
makeFromGDF("karate.gdf")
frLayout()
addSlide("The club before the split")
colorize(club)
addSlide("The two factions")
slides()
```

How it works. `addSlide(note)` saves the graph and the camera as a slide, and the Slides panel plays them, morphing from one to the next.

Save your work and your method Basic

```
makeFromGDF("karate.gdf")
louvainClusters(); colorize(modularity_class)
saveSession("karate-analysis.guess")
history()
```

How it works. `saveSession` writes everything (graph, fields, states, view) to one file that `makeFromSession` (or *File* → *Open*) restores. `history()` lists the commands you ran, which is your method: save it as a `.py` file and `execfile` replays it on new data.